

Seek

A friendlier way to find music on Soulseek.

Thanks for trying this. It is an early build, so a few rough edges are expected and honestly the point.

The thing to try is label digging: paste a record label's page and Seek works through its whole catalogue with you. That is what this beta is for.

This guide covers opening it the first time - macOS will object, and that is normal - then signing in, and what would help most to hear back.

You will need

A Mac, and a Soulseek account. If you already use Soulseek or Nicotine+, your usual username and password are fine.

Opening it the first time

Apple charges developers a yearly fee to have apps recognised. This one has not paid it, so macOS shows a warning the first time. Nothing is wrong with the app or the download. Here is the way past it.

WHAT YOU WILL SEE

"Apple could not verify "Seek" is free of malware."

1

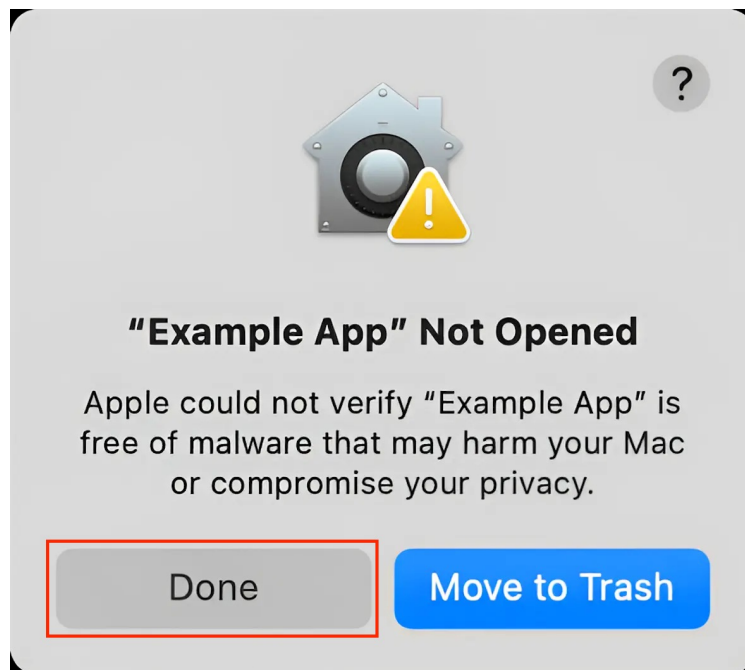
Unzip it and drag Seek into Applications

Same as any other app. Double-click the zip if it has not already unpacked.

2

Open it, then click Done - NOT Move to Trash

Double-click Seek. The message above appears. The blue button says Move to Trash, and clicking it deletes the app. Click Done instead. This first attempt is what tells macOS you want to run it.



The blue button DELETES the app. Click Done. Apple's own example is pictured here; yours will say Seek.

3

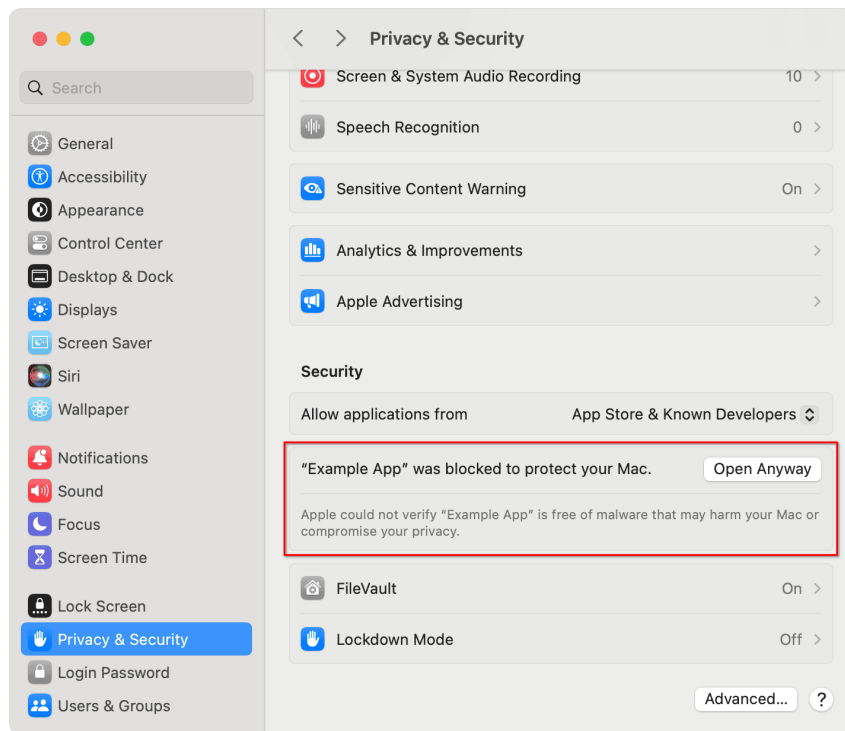
Go to System Settings, then Privacy & Security

Scroll down that page. Near the bottom there is a line saying Seek was blocked, with a button beside it.

4

Click Open Anyway, and confirm

You may be asked for your Mac password. That is macOS checking it is really you, not the app asking for anything.



Privacy & Security, scrolled down. Open Anyway is the button to press.

That is it. macOS remembers the decision and will not ask again.

Signing in

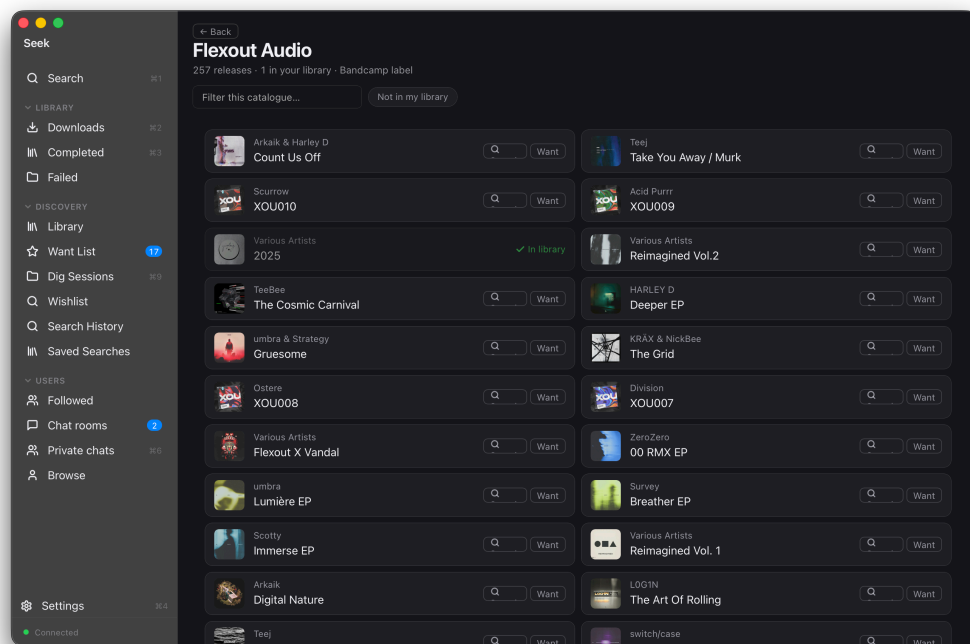
Open Seek, click Settings in the bottom-left, and sign in with your Soulseek username and password. If you have never used Soulseek, typing a new username signs you up — there is no separate registration.

Everything else is optional. Searching and downloading work straight away; extras like cover art and playlist import are switched off until you add your own free keys, and the guide on the website explains those.

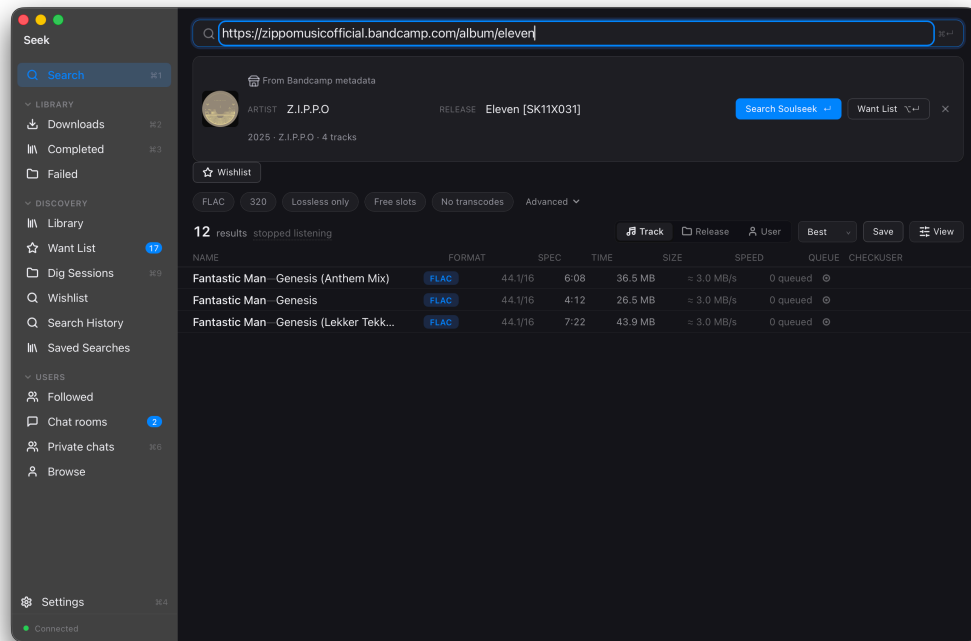
What this beta is really for

Paste a record label's page - from Bandcamp or Discogs - into the search box. Seek reads the whole catalogue, then helps you go through it looking for the tracks on Soulseek. Anything already in your library is marked, so what is left is the gap.

That is the part worth hammering. Try a label you already collect and see whether it finds things you did not know were there.



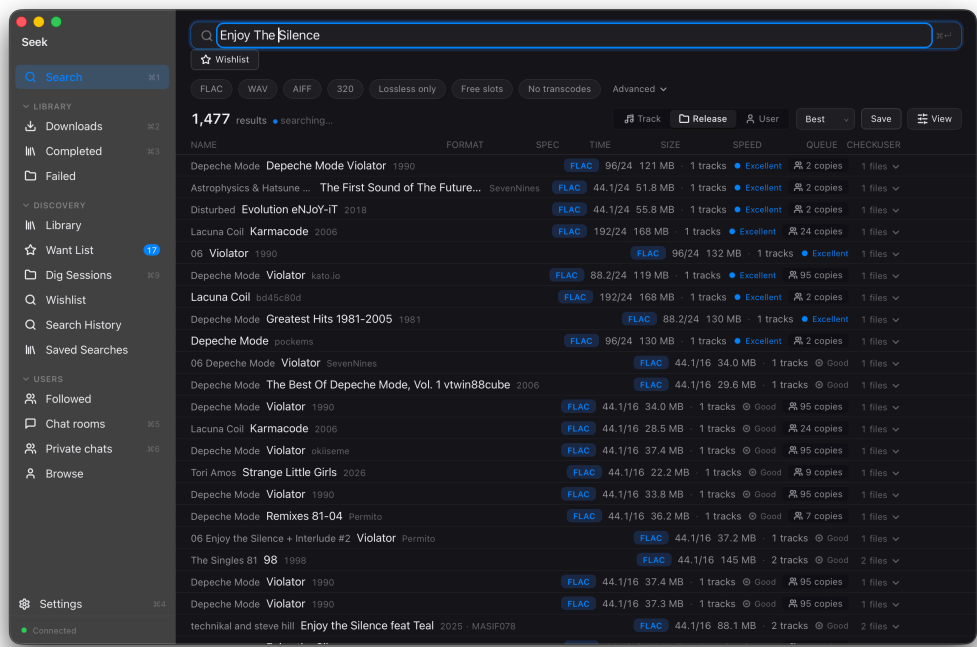
A label's whole catalogue, pulled from one pasted link. The tick marks a release already in your library.



A single album link works the same way - artist, release and track count read straight off the page, ready to search for.

Searching

Ordinary searches work too. Results arrive gathered into albums rather than as a heap of loose files, and where several people have the same record Seek says how many - so you can compare them and pick, instead of the app deciding for you.



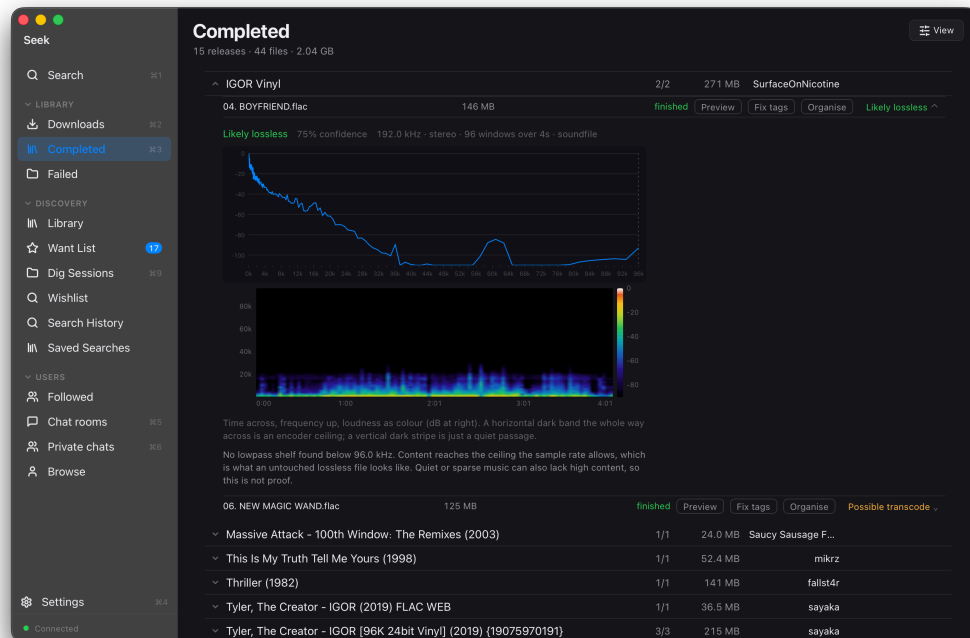
The count on the right - 95 copies, 24 copies - is how many people have that same record.

[still to capture: 04-compare.png]

Click that count and every copy is listed side by side: tracks, quality, size, who is free now. Press Get on the one you want.

It shows its working

A file can claim to be high quality without being it - re-saved from a smaller one, with detail that never comes back. Seek looks at the sound itself and shows what it found rather than just stamping a verdict on it.



Loudness across frequency and time. A flat cut-off near the top means detail was thrown away. Note it ends with "this is not proof" - it tells you what it saw, not what to think.

What would help most

Anything at all is welcome, but these parts are the least tested and the most likely to be wrong:

Digging a label

The main thing. Paste a label you collect and work through it. Did it find anything you did not know about? Did it miss releases you know exist? Was the catalogue right?

Choosing a copy

When several people have the same record, does seeing them side by side help you decide, or is it just more to read?

Chat

Rooms and private messages. Only one real conversation has ever happened in it, so it is the least proven part of the app.

Importing a YouTube playlist

Paste a playlist link and it should turn into a list of things to look for. Odd track titles are where it will struggle.

Anything confusing

If you could not work out what something meant, that is a bug in the app, not in you.

One thing worth saying

Seek is just a client, like any other. What you search for and share is your own business, and your own responsibility.

Seek is unofficial and not connected to Soulseek or Nicotine+. It is built on Nicotine+ and shares its licence, GPL-3.0-or-later.